

Claude Code Cheat Sheet

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

General Controls

Ctrl

C

Cancel input/generation

Ctrl

D

Exit session

Ctrl

L

Clear screen

Ctrl

O

Toggle verbose output

Ctrl

R

Reverse search history

Ctrl

G

Open prompt in editor

Ctrl

B

Background running task

Ctrl

T

Toggle task list

Ctrl

V

Paste image

Ctrl

F

Kill background agents (x2)

Esc

Esc

Rewind / undo

Mode Switching

Shift

Tab

Cycle permission modes

Alt

P

Switch model

Alt

T

Toggle thinking

Input

\

Enter

Newline (quick)

Ctrl

J

Newline (control seq)

Prefixes

/

Slash command

!

Direct bash

@

File mention + autocomplete

Session Picker

T

Navigate

...

Expand/collapse

P

Preview

R

Rename

/

Search

A

All projects

B

Current branch

MCP SERVERS

Add Servers

--transport http

Remote HTTP (recommended)

--transport stdio

Local process

--transport sse

Remote SSE

Scopes

Local

.claude.json (per project)

Project

.mcp.json (shared/VCS)

User

~/claude.json (global)

Manage

/mcp

Interactive UI

claude mcp list

List all servers

claude mcp serve

CC as MCP server

Elicitation

Servers request input mid-task

SLASH COMMANDS

Session

/clear

Clear conversation

/compact [focus]

Compact context

/resume

Resume/switch session

/rename [name]

Name current session

/branch [name]

Branch conversation (/fork alias)

/cost

Token usage stats

/context

Visualize context (grid)

/diff

Interactive diff viewer

/copy

Copy last response

/export

Export conversation

Config

/config

Open settings

/model [model]

Switch model (→ effort)

/fast [on/off]

Toggle fast mode

/vim

Toggle vim mode

/theme

Change color theme

/permissions

View/update permissions

/effort [level]

Set effort (low/med/high)

/color [color]

Set prompt-bar color

/keybindings

Customize keyboard shortcuts

/terminal-setup

Configure terminal keybindings

Tools

/init

Create CLAUDE.md

/memory

Edit CLAUDE.md files

/mcp

Manage MCP servers

/hooks

Manage hooks

/skills

List available skills

/agents

Manage agents

/chrome

Chrome integration

/reload-plugins

Hot-reload plugins

/add-dir <path>

Add working directory

Special

/btw <question>

Side question (no context)

/plan [desc]

Plan mode (+ auto-start)

/loop [interval]

Schedule recurring task

/voice

Push-to-talk voice (20 langs)

/doctor

Diagnose installation

/rc

Enable remote control

/pr-comments [PR]

Fetch GitHub PR comments

/stats

Usage streaks & prefs

/insights

Analyze sessions report

/desktop

Continue in Desktop app

/remote-control

Bridge terminal to claude.ai/code

/usage

Plan limits & rate status

/schedule

Cloud scheduled tasks

/security-review

Security analysis of changes

/help

Show help + commands

/feedback

Submit feedback (alias: /bug)

/release-notes

View full changelog

/stickers

Order stickers!

MEMORY & FILES

CLAUDE.md Locations

./CLAUDE.md

Project (team-shared)

~/claude/CLAUDE.md

Personal (all projects)

etc/claude-code/

Managed (org-wide)

Rules & Import

.claude/rules/*.md

Project rules

~/claude/rules/*.md

User rules

paths: frontmatter

Path-specific rules

@path/to/file

Import in CLAUDE.md

Auto Memory

~/claude/projects/<proj>/memory/

MEMORY.md + topic files, auto-loaded

WORKFLOWS & TIPS

Plan Mode

Shift

Tab

Normal → Auto-Accept → Plan

--permission-mode plan

Start in plan mode

Thinking & Effort

Alt

T

Toggle thinking on/off

"ultrathink"

Max effort for turn

Ctrl

O

See thinking (verbose)

/effort

low · med · high

Git Worktrees

--worktree name

Isolated branch per feature

isolation: worktree

Agent in own worktree

sparsePaths

Checkout only needed dirs

/batch

Auto-creates worktrees

Voice Mode

/voice

Enable push-to-talk

Space

(hold) Record, release to send

20 languages

EN, ES, FR, DE, CZ, PL...

Context Management

/context

Usage + optimization tips

/compact [focus]

Compress with focus

Auto-compact

~95% capacity

1M context

Opus 4.6 (Max/Team/Ent)

CLAUDE.md

Survives compaction!

Session Power Moves

claude

Continue last conv

claude -r "name"

Resume by name

/btw question

Side Q, no context cost

SDK / Headless

claude -p "query"

Non-interactive

--output-format json

Structured output

--max-budget-USD 5

Cost cap

cat file | claude -p

Pipe input

Scheduling & Remote

/loop 5m msg

Recurring task

/rc

Remote control

--remote

Web session on claude.ai

CONFIG & ENV

Config Files

~/claude/settings.json

User settings

.claude/settings.json

Project (shared)

.claude/settings.local.json

Local only

~/claude.json

OAuth, MCP, state

.mcp.json

Project MCP servers

Key Settings

modelOverrides

Map model picker → custom IDs

autoMemoryDirectory

Custom memory dir

worktree.sparsePaths

Sparse checkout dirs

Key Env Vars

ANTHROPIC_API_KEY

ANTHROPIC_MODEL

CLAUDE_CODE_EFFORT_LEVEL

low/med/high

MAX_THINKING_TOKENS

0=off

ANTHROPIC_CUSTOM_MODEL_OPTION

Custom/model entry

CLAUDE_CODE_PLUGIN_SEED_DIR

Multiple plugin seed dirs

CLAUDECODE

Detect CC shell (=1)

IS_DEMO

Demo mode (hide email/org)

SKILLS & AGENTS

Built-in Skills

/simplify

Code review (3 parallel agents)

/batch

Large parallel changes (5-30 worktrees)

/debug [desc]

Troubleshoot from debug log

/loop [interval]

Recurring scheduled task

/claude-api

Load API + SDK reference

Custom Skill Locations

.claude/skills/<name>/

Project skills

~/claude/skills/<name>/

Personal skills

Skill Frontmatter

description

Auto-invocation trigger

allowed-tools

Skip permission prompts

model

Override model for skill

effort

Override effort level

context: fork

Run in subagent

\$ARGUMENTS

User input placeholder

\$(CLAUDE_SKILL_DIR)

Skill's own directory

!`cmd`

Dynamic context injection

Built-in Agents

Explore

Fast read-only (Haiku)

Plan

Research for plan mode

General

Full tools, complex tasks

Bash

Terminal separate context

Agent Frontmatter

permissionMode

default/acceptEdits/plan/dontAsk/bypass

isolation: worktree

Run in git worktree

memory: user|project

Persistent memory

background: true

Background task

maxTurns

Limit agentic turns

SendMessage

Resume agents (replaces resume)

CLI & FLAGS

Core Commands

claude

Interactive

claude "q"

With prompt

claude -p "q"

Headless

claude -c

Continue last

claude -r "n"

Resume

claude update

Update

Key Flags

--model

Set model

-w

Git worktree

-n / --name

Session name

--add-dir

Add dir

--agent

Use agent

--allowedTools

Pre-approve

--output-format json/stream

--json-schema

Structured

--max-turns

Limit turns

--max-budget-USD

Cost cap

--console

Auth via Anthropic Console

--verbose

Verbose

--bare

Minimal headless (no hooks/LSP)

--channels

Permission relay / MCP push

--remote

Web session

--effort

low/med/high/max

--permission-mode

plan/default/...

--dangerously-skip-permissions

Skip all prompts

--chrome

Chrome

Permission Modes: default prompts acceptEdits auto-accept edits plan read-only dontAsk deny unless allowed bypassPermissions skip all --dangerously-skip-permissions CLI flag

Key Env Vars: ANTHROPIC_API_KEY ANTHROPIC_MODEL CLAUDE_CODE_EFFORT_LEVEL (low/med/high) MAX_THINKING_TOKENS (0=off) CLAUDE_CODE_MAX_OUTPUT_TOKENS (def 32K) CLAUDE_CODE_DISABLE_CRON